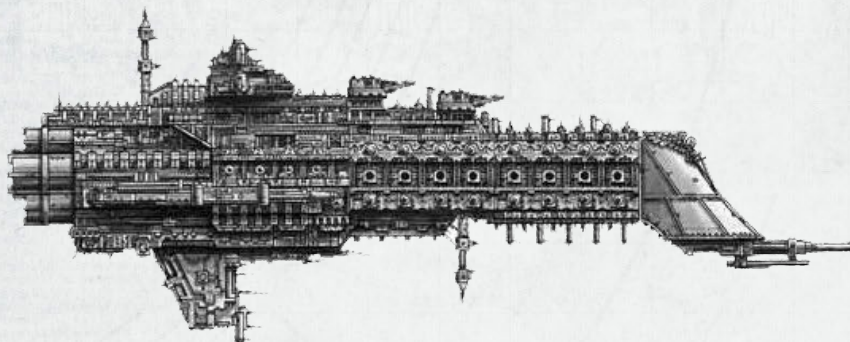


Famous Ships: Nemesis, Gorgon, Medusa, Long Serpent



TYPE/HITS	SPEED	TURNS	SHIELDS	ARMOUR	TURRETS
Cruiser/8	25 cm	45°	2	6+ front / 5+	2
ARMAMENT		RANGE/SPEED		FIREPOWER/STR	FIRE ARC
Port weapons battery		60 cm		6	Left
Starboard weapons battery		60 cm		6	Right
Port weapons battery		45 cm		4	Left
Starboard weapons battery		45 cm		4	Right
Dorsal lance battery		60 cm		2	Left/front/right
Prow nova cannon		30 – 150 cm		1	Front
SPECIAL Mercury class battlecruisers are fitted with up-rated engineering plants that increase its speed and provide it with greater firepower at the expense of survivability. When reduced to zero hits, it rolls 3D6 for catastrophic damage and adds the result (any roll greater than 12 counts as 12).					
OPTIONS - Can be refitted with improved weapons batteries (like the <i>Nemesis</i> and <i>Medusa</i> after the Stabulo Campaign). Its 45cm weapons batteries increase their range to 60cm for +10 points. - Can replace its Nova Cannon with strength 6 torpedoes for -20 points (like the <i>Gorgon</i> which had its prow severely damaged during the Stabulo Campaign).					

In the waning years of Abaddon's 12th Black Crusade, the Adeptus Mechanicus Artisans of Bakka and the officers of the Tempestus battle fleets faced a dilemma. In supporting Battlefleet Obscuras, the problem with pirate bands had become acute and the lack of speed among the standard Imperial cruiser designs meant that the tactical initiative remained with the pirates. At the direction of Admiral Knight's bridge, the Tech Mages of Bakka set about to construct a new battle cruiser design fitting for the strategy and tactics of the battlefleet yet be able to meet this threat. Through a rather straightforward merging of existing technologies, the Adeptus Mechanicus were able to devise a solution in less than two centuries. It is widely believed that this is the fastest a new capital ship design has ever come to fruition in several millennia, and thus the Mercury class battlecruiser came into being. Built from the keel up to prosecute raiders, the Mercury combines a basic cruiser layout with the engineering suite normally used on a battleship. The result is a faster much more powerful cruiser with the speed to keep up with the raiders and the firepower to deal with them as an independent unit. All this improved performance came at a price. While the engines produced battleship power, the armour protection remained that of a cruiser. When hit by multiple salvos from Chaos raiders in 467.M41, the *Scylla* suffered a powerful warp drive implosion, destroying her entire squadron of assigned escorts and heavily damaging the battleship *Mailed Fist*. The plasma drive overload that destroyed the *Medusa* also shattered the Lunar cruiser *Lord Chalfont*, leaving a convoy of transports to

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